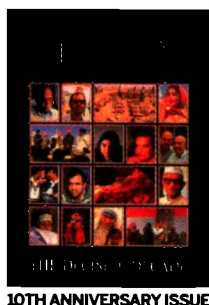
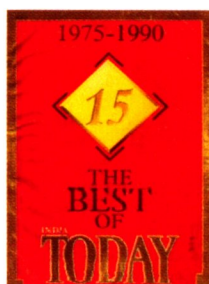


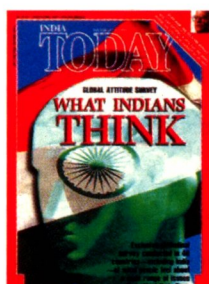
FROM THE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF



10TH ANNIVERSARY ISSUE



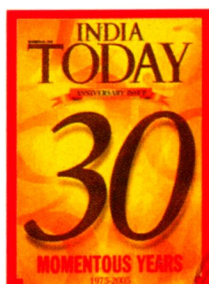
15TH ANNIVERSARY ISSUE



20TH ANNIVERSARY ISSUE



25TH ANNIVERSARY ISSUE



30TH ANNIVERSARY ISSUE

There are 83 million people in India who are 33 years old. With this issue, which is our 1,119th, we join their ranks. I believe we are the only English newsmagazine of that age in India.

As a human being, 33 years is considered an ideal age, when energy, ambition and maturity combine to elevate men, and women, to the prime of their life. At INDIA TODAY, celebrating the 33rd year of our existence, we would like to believe we are at a similar stage. We've been a leader in the newsmagazine segment for the last 27 years and that too by a long stretch. More importantly, we would like to believe that over the last three decades or so, INDIA TODAY has made a difference by adding value to people's lives, giving them a greater understanding of events and trends and their implications, expanding their knowledge of important contemporary issues and, above all, making a significant contribution to the level and quality of public discourse. The dramatic growth in readership we have experienced over the last three decades suggests we have maintained our credibility and relevance, and there is immense satisfaction in that achievement.

In the last three decades, India has experienced some amazing transformations. So have we as a magazine, adding new sections, new design changes and turning from a fortnightly to a weekly over 11 years ago.

Reading through the pages of this special anniversary issue, I was struck by the shocking paradox of our changes as a nation and society during this time. From a poverty-stricken Third World country happy with a Hindu rate of growth to rampant consumerism and a booming economy that is the envy of the world is perhaps the biggest story of the 33 years we have reported on India.

The changes in the automobile sector where we have gone up from three

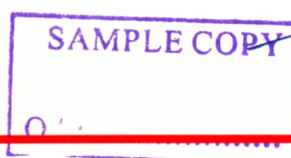
manufacturers who produced 23,000 cars to 50 manufacturers who make more than a million and the proliferation of private airlines have transformed the way Indians travel. The telecom revolution with over 325 million mobile phones in a country where one had to wait years to get a landline has connected us like never before. The advent of satellite television with over 300 channels available at the press of a button and mushrooming multiplexes has changed how Indians entertain themselves. There are many more such changes that stem from our liberalised economy on which we have extensively reported in the past 33 years.

That's the good news. While the economy has revolutionised our lives, what has not changed is our politics and governance. That's the paradox.

Dynasties and ageing leaders continue to rule the roost while across the world dynamic younger politicians are increasingly in charge. Corruption remains endemic, the bureaucracy is burdensome and unresponsive as ever. Vote bank and caste politics is the order of the day. One militancy has been replaced by another. Kashmir is still unresolved. We are still at loggerheads with Pakistan. Reservation still gets people on the boil. Even after spending thousands of crores of rupees we are yet to clean the Yamuna and the Ganges. The list is long and depressing.

This issue is a record of all this done in the form of lists. It has been put together by Executive Editor Kaveree Bamzai and her young team relying on the able research skills of Chief Information Manager Rajesh Sharma who sifted through over 1,000 issues of the magazine.

I believe that a generation which ignores its history has no past—and no future. As a magazine, we try to do our bit to prevent that by connecting the dots of the past to the matrix of the future.



Aroon Purie
(Aroon Purie)